

CALIFORNIA SECURITY GUARD

LICENSING TRAINING PROGRAM

Bureau of Security & Investigative Services (BSIS)
Complete Compliance Course — 2026 Edition

COURSE OVERVIEW

Module 1

Power to Arrest (3 hrs)

Module 2

Appropriate Use of Force (5 hrs)

Module 3

Public Relations & Community (4 hrs)

Module 4

Observation & Documentation (4 hrs)

Module 5

Communication & Significance (4 hrs)

Module 6

Liability & Legal Aspects (4 hrs)

Module 7

Elective Courses Overview (8 hrs)

Module 8

Annual Continuing Education (8 hrs/yr)

ELIGIBILITY REQUIREMENTS



Age 18+

Must be at least 18 years old
(BPC Section 7582.8)



Background Check

DOJ + FBI criminal history check
via Live Scan fingerprinting
(BPC §§7581, 7583.9)



Power to Arrest

Complete 8-hr PTA + Appropriate
Use of Force training BEFORE
applying for registration



No Disqualifying Crimes

No convictions constituting
grounds for denial under
BPC Section 480

MODULE 1: POWER TO ARREST

3 HOURS

 BPC §7583.7 | DCA Power to Arrest & Appropriate Use of Force Training Manual (July 2023)

- Overview of Power to Arrest manual and subject matter
- Responsibilities & ethics in citizen arrest and types of encounters
- Relationship between security personnel and peace officers
- Limitations on security personnel's power to arrest
- Background on private security industry & contractual obligations
- Restrictions on searches and seizures
- Criminal and civil liabilities — personal & employer
- Trespass law
- Ethics and communications
- Emergency situation response, including medical emergencies
- Security officer safety



Exam required — must score 100% to pass (BPC §7583.7)

MODULE 2: APPROPRIATE USE OF FORCE

5 HOURS

- Legal standards for use of force
- (Statutes, contracts, civil/criminal liability)
- Objectively reasonable force ★ IN-PERSON
- (Standard, restraint techniques, force options, scenarios)
- Duty to intercede
- Supervisory responsibilities & incident reporting
- (BPC §§7583.2, 7583.4, 7574.37)
- Use of force review & analysis ★ IN-PERSON

- De-escalation & interpersonal communication ★ IN-PERSON
- (Time, distance, cover, 4 concepts, real scenarios)
- Implicit/explicit bias & cultural competency
- (Strategies for diverse communities)
- Interacting with persons with disabilities/behavioral health issues
- Use of force scenario training ★ IN-PERSON
- (Shoot/don't-shoot, real-time force decisions)
- Mental health & policing — bias and stigma
- Active shooter situations
- (Recognition, roles, responsibilities)

2026 BSIS UPDATE

HYBRID TRAINING NOW REQUIRED

SB 652 (Effective Jan 1, 2026)

Power to Arrest training must be completed within 6 months BEFORE applying. All training certified by a single provider.

Minimum 4 Hrs In-Person

The initial 8-hour PTA + AUF course is now HYBRID: at least 4 hours must be instructor-led in person.

Single Provider Rule

All initial training must be delivered and certified by one approved BSIS provider. Split-provider training no longer compliant.

Fee Increases (Oct 1, 2025)

Registration, renewal, PPO, and certification fees have been increased under Title 16 CCR.

MANDATORY COURSES — 16 HOURS TOTAL

Public Relations & Community 4 hrs

- Gender & Racial Harassment Recognition
- Stereotyping & Attitude Awareness
- Verbal Skills / Crisis Intervention
- Intro to Diversity
- Substance Abuse & Mental Illness
- Ethics & Professionalism

Observation & Documentation 4 hrs

- Report Writing
- English as a Second Language
- Observation & Patrol Techniques
- Asking Appropriate Questions
- Observing Suspects / Suspicious Activity

Communication & Its Significance 4 hrs

- Internal: Protocols, Radio/Monitors, Tech
- External: Emergency/First Responders
- Medical Personnel coordination
- Police/Sheriff/Enforcement contacts
- City & Government Services

Liability & Legal Aspects 4 hrs

- Personal / Contractor / Employer Liability
- Criminal, Civil, Administrative
- BSIS Code & Regulations
- Role of a Security Guard

First 2 courses: within 30 days of guard card issuance | Remaining 2 courses: within 6 months (BPC §7583.6b)

ELECTIVE COURSES — SELECT 8 HOURS

- Post Orders & Assignments (4 hrs max)
- Employer Policies / Orientation (4 hrs max)
- Evacuation Procedures (2 hrs max)
- Officer Safety (4 hrs max)
- Arrests, Search & Seizure (4 hrs max)
- Access Control (2 hrs max)
- Trespass (4 hrs max)
- Laws, Codes & Regulations (2 hrs max)
- First Aid / CPR (4 hrs max)

- Handling Difficult People (4 hrs max)
- Workplace Violence (4 hrs max)
- Chemical Agents (4 hrs max)
- Preserving the Incident Scene (4 hrs max)
- Crowd Control (4 hrs max)
- Driver Safety (4 hrs max)
- Supervision (4 hrs max)
- Courtroom Demeanor (4 hrs max)
- Parking / Traffic Control (2 hrs max)

- Radio Procedures (2 hrs max)
- Firearms Training (BSIS Cert) (8 hrs max)
- Baton Training (BSIS Cert) (4 hrs max)
- School Security Guard Training (8 hrs max)
- Intro to Executive Protection (4 hrs max)
- Annual Firearms Requalification (4 hrs max)
- Fire Safety Course (4 hrs max)
- Stun Gun / Air Taser Course (4 hrs max)
- WMD & Terrorism Awareness (4 hrs max)

TRAINING TIMELINE

Before Application

8 Hours — PTA + AUF

Complete Power to Arrest (3 hrs) + Appropriate Use of Force (5 hrs) with BSIS-approved single provider. Minimum 4 hrs must be in-person. Pass 100% exam. Receive certificate.

Day 0 — Guard Card Issued

Registration + Live Scan

Submit BSIS application + \$50 fee. Fingerprints via Live Scan to DOJ + FBI. Allow 4–6 weeks processing. Guard card issued once DOJ/FBI clears.

Within 30 Days

16 Hours Required

2 mandatory courses (8 hrs) + 8 hrs elective = 16 hrs. Begin working as a guard while completing remaining hours.

Within 6 Months

32 Hours Total Complete

Remaining 2 mandatory courses (8 hrs) + 8 hrs elective = additional 16 hrs. Total 32 hrs of skills training done.

Annually Thereafter

8 Hours CE Required

Minimum 2 hrs Appropriate Use of Force review + 6 hrs mandatory/elective. Records maintained by PPO and guard. Required per BPC §7583.6(e).

DOCUMENTATION & RECORD KEEPING

GUARD RESPONSIBILITIES

- Keep all certificates of completion
- Retain until registration expires or is canceled
- Store both digital and paper copies
- Track serial numbers and provider info for each certificate
- Must pass 100% exam for PTA/AUF — keep exam record
- Maintain copy of current guard card on person while on duty

PPO / EMPLOYER RESPONSIBILITIES

- Maintain training records for ALL officers
- Provide copy of certificate to each officer
- Make records available to BSIS upon request
- Retain records for duration of employment
- Track 30-day and 6-month compliance windows
- PPOs AND training facilities are liable for inadequate training
- Approved trainer must be licensed by BSIS

SPECIALIZED PERMITS & ADD-ONS

Exposed Firearms Permit

BPC \$7583.35 / Firearms Permit Fact Sheet

- BSIS Certified Firearms Training (8 hrs max)
- Annual Requalification (4 hrs max)
- Must be registered security guard
- Approval via BSIS Verify a License

Baton Permit

BPC \$7583.33

- Must be a registered security guard
- Complete BSIS-approved Baton Training (4 hrs max)
- Training facility must be Bureau-approved
- Verify facility via BSIS Verify a License page

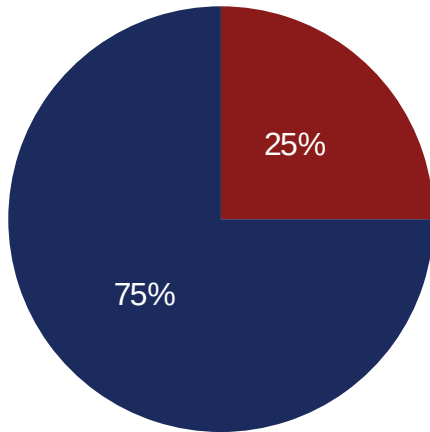
Tear Gas Permit

BPC \$7583.35 / PC \$22835

- Complete approved tear gas training course
- Course provided by Bureau-approved facility
- Confirm facility offers tear gas training before arrival
- Combined with other chemical agent training

ANNUAL CONTINUING EDUCATION — 8 HRS/YEAR

REQUIRED COMPOSITION OF 8 ANNUAL HOURS



■ AUF Review (minimum) ■ Mandatory/Elective Courses

Minimum 2 hrs:

Review of Appropriate Use of Force topics (§I.B. Appendix of PTA manual)

Remaining 6 hrs:

Any mandatory or elective courses applicable to private security work

Who can deliver:

Independent training entity OR the employer (employer must evaluate guard skills)

Certificate:

Certificate of Completion issued per Title 16 CCR §643(b) for each course completed

APPLICATION PROCESS — STEP BY STEP

1 Complete PTA + AUF Training

8 hrs with BSIS-approved provider within 6 months of applying. Get certificate.

2 Live Scan Fingerprinting

Submit fingerprints to DOJ + FBI electronically. Pay Live Scan operator fee.

3 Submit BSIS Application

Apply via BreZE online portal or mail paper application to BSIS (West Sacramento, CA 95798-9002) with fee.

4 Processing Period

Allow 4–6 weeks. BSIS reviews DOJ/FBI responses. Processing may be longer during high volume.

5 Guard Card Issued

Registration appears on BSIS Verify a License page. Begin work as registered guard.

6 Complete 32-Hr Skills Training

16 hrs within 30 days, remaining 16 hrs within 6 months of registration. Maintain all certificates.

KNOWLEDGE CHECK

Q1 How many hours of initial training are required BEFORE applying for a guard card?

 8 hours (PTA + AUF) — completed within 6 months of application

Q2 Within how many days of guard card issuance must the first 16 hours be completed?

 Within 30 days of registration

Q3 What score is required to pass the Power to Arrest exam?

 100% — no partial credit

Q4 How many annual continuing education hours are required?

 8 hours, including at least 2 hours of AUF review

TRAINING COMPLETE

You are now prepared to meet California's
BSIS security guard licensing requirements.

Keep your certificates. Know your timeline. Stay compliant.

Private Security LA Worldwide | gopslaw.com

Maccess Inc. | PPO Lic. #122729
5665 W Wilshire Blvd Ste 1129, Los Angeles CA 90036